assistant access to check inventory, reserve books, or place orders. Similarly, community forums can expose endpoints like `get_news` or `post_message`, enabling users to interact with site content entirely through conversation.

The key implication is that the MCP may become the new standard: the "Add us to your AI" mechanism. Just as websites once added RSS feeds or apps prompted users to install a mobile client, businesses will increasingly provide MCP endpoints so that their services are directly accessible from chat-based interfaces.

Over time, instead of relying on visual interfaces, users may engage primarily through AI assistants that call MCP-enabled services behind the scenes, streamlining workflows and creating entirely new user experiences.

12.6.3 MCP directories and registries

Discovering useful MCP servers is still a challenge. Right now, developers often rely on community recommendations, forum posts, or small niche catalogs. There isn't yet a single, fully mature directory, so finding the right server for your needs can feel like searching in the early days of the web. Figure 12.10 illustrates the MCP discovery ecosystem, showing how developers find and access MCP servers efficiently.

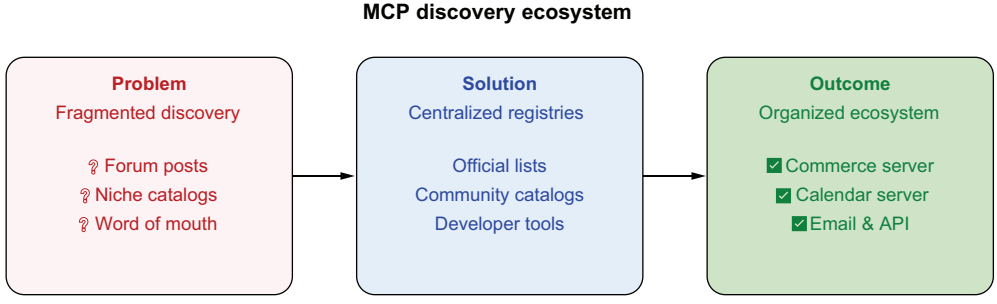


Figure 12.10 Developers face fragmented discovery across forums, niche catalogs, and word of mouth. Centralized registries and community catalogs improve access to those services by creating an organized and trusted ecosystem for commerce, calendar, email, and API servers.

Emerging solutions are starting to fill this gap. The official MCP Registry (https://github.com/modelcontextprotocol/registry) provides a centralized listing of available servers, though it is still growing and adding content. Community-curated catalogs, like Glama and Pulse MCP, offer collections of trusted servers. CLI tools such as `mcpreg` (https://github.com/trose/mcp-registry-cli) allow developers to browse, search, and install MCP servers directly from the command line. Even app-based catalogs are appearing, letting users discover and install MCP endpoints with a single click, similar to an app store experience.

This ecosystem is comparable to the pre–search engine stage of the internet. Over time, we can expect richer directories with ratings, categories, reviews, and possibly